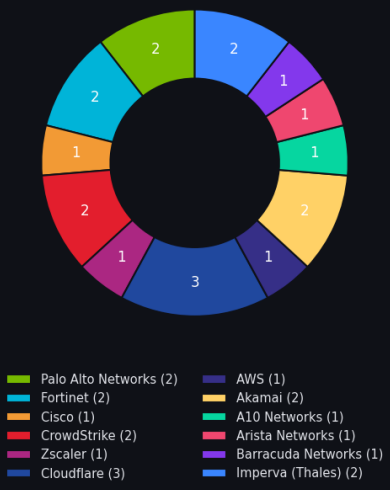
F5 Daily Briefing – Friday, October 30 – Sunday, November 01, 2026

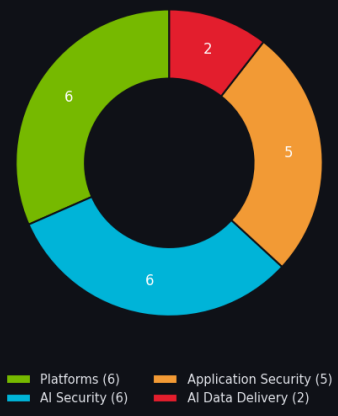
Daily competitive intelligence covering 22 F5 competitors

22	19	12	4
COMPETITORS TRACKED	ANNOUNCEMENTS	ACTIVE	ACTIVE CATEGORIES

Announcements by Competitor



Announcements by Category



ALL ANNOUNCEMENTS (19)

Research · Palo Alto Networks · Platforms · Oct 30, 2026

PAN-OS Firewalls Compromised in Chained PHP2Shell Attacks

A suspected China-nexus actor chained the PHP2Shell vulnerabilities with a Linux kernel privilege escalation (CVE-2026-46300) to get root on 25 PAN-OS firewalls and management servers in the U.S., Japan, Taiwan and South Korea, including at least two U.S. government-linked servers. The actor used an AI-enabled scanning platform. Palo Alto Networks says about 0.02% of its global firewall base was exposed and urges patching and restricting management access to trusted IPs.

Source: https://www.cybersecuritydive.com/news/palo-alto-networks-firewalls-compromised-chained-attacks-php2shell/873323/

Partnership · Palo Alto Networks · AI Security · Oct 30, 2026

Frontier AI Critical Defense Program Adds Anthropic, OpenAI and Others

Palo Alto Networks expanded its Frontier AI Critical Defense Program, which uses Frontier Virtual Patching to shield critical-infrastructure operators from AI-driven exploits at the network layer. New participants include Anthropic, OpenAI, Mitsubishi, Axis Communications, Health-ISAC, EPRI and Akrites, joining IBM, Microsoft, Siemens and Idaho National Laboratory. The program targets OT, healthcare, energy and open-source environments with strict uptime requirements.

Source: https://www.techpartner.news/news/palo-alto-networks-launches-frontier-ai-critical-defense-program-630023

Partnership · Fortinet · Platforms · Oct 30, 2026

NEC Achieves Fortinet Engage Preferred Services Partner Designation

NEC was named an Engage Preferred Services Partner in Fortinet's Engage Partner Program, recognizing its ability to deploy, operate and maintain end-to-end Fortinet security solutions. The designation expands NEC's Fortinet-based managed security services, especially in Southeast Asia, with direct Fortinet expert support.

Source: https://www.nec.com/en/press/202610/global_20261030_01.html

Event Fortinet AI Security Nov 01, 2026

Fortinet Previews Nov 4–5 Security Operations Summit on AI-Native SecOps

Fortinet is heading into a virtual Security Operations Summit on November 4–5, 2026. Sessions cover AI-powered threat detection, point-of-attack defenses and agentic AI for SOCs, featuring Fortinet experts, IDC analysis and customer speakers. Americas sessions run Nov 4 and EMEA/APAC sessions Nov 5.

Source: https://www.ad-hoc-news.de/boerse/news/corporate-news/fortinet-stock-heads-into-november-4-5-ai-security-summit/70442346

Event Cisco Platforms Oct 30, 2026

Cisco Partner Summit 2026: Cisco IQ for Partners GA, Model Foundry and Secure AI Factory Additions

At Partner Summit 2026 in Vancouver, Cisco made Cisco IQ for Partners generally available with partner branding, API access and an MCP server for managed services. It announced Cisco Model Foundry for partner post-training of Cisco models (GA June 2027) and Ecosystem Deal Registration. Cisco also added Live Protect, AI Defense and Splunk AI to the Cisco Secure AI Factory with NVIDIA, and put Supermicro rack-scale AI systems on its global price list.

Source: https://futurumgroup.com/insights/cisco-partner-summit-2026-an-energized-cisco-bets-on-partner-led-ai/

Product Launch CrowdStrike AI Security Oct 30, 2026

CrowdStrike Agent Graph Traces AI Agent Actions on the Endpoint

CrowdStrike introduced Agent Graph, which links AI-layer activity (prompts, models, tools, skills) to endpoint activity (processes, files, network) through the Falcon sensor. Falcon Guardian adds three views built on it: agent inventory, session graph and a 0–100 agent threat score. Agent hooks for Claude Code, OpenAI Codex, GitHub Copilot, Cursor and OpenCode capture prompts and tool I/O and can block dangerous actions before they run.

Source: https://www.crowdstrike.com/en-us/blog/crowdstrike-agent-graph-shows-how-agents-act-on-endpoint/

Product Update CrowdStrike AI Security Oct 30, 2026

Falcon Adversary OverWatch Expands Threat Hunting to AI Agents and Google Cloud

CrowdStrike extended Falcon Adversary OverWatch managed hunting to AI applications and autonomous agents monitored by Falcon Guardian, with 24/7 coverage that includes AI coding assistants. Hunting now also uses Google Cloud telemetry to catch service-account abuse, privilege escalation and lateral movement, adding Google Cloud to existing AWS and Azure coverage.

Source: https://www.crowdstrike.com/en-us/blog/crowdstrike-expands-threat-hunting-across-ai-and-google-cloud/

Product Update Zscaler Platforms Oct 30, 2026

Zscaler GovCloud October 2026 Product Updates

Zscaler's October GovCloud roundup adds Endpoint DLP device control, real-time PDF OCR and Zoom AI transcript/summary scanning to ZIA, and fixes a File Type Control evasion flaw (CVE-2026-25684). ZDX gains Real User Monitoring. Client Connector 5.0 for Windows brings a new UI, SSID-based trusted networks, TLS 1.3 and Endpoint DLP on ARM Windows.

Source: https://www.zscaler.com/blogs/product-insights/what-s-new-govcloud-october-2026-zscaler-product-updates

Product Launch Cloudflare Platforms Oct 30, 2026

Cloudflare Services for Private Origins Now Generally Available

Cloudflare made services for private origins generally available. Customers can point a proxied DNS record at a private IP and get WAF, bot management, rate limiting, caching, transform rules and Workers without exposing a public IP or opening inbound firewall ports. It requires a Private Origins entitlement, Cloudflare One connectivity (IPsec, GRE, CNI, Tunnel or Mesh) and Unified Routing. A closed beta for private-to-private traffic is planned for early 2027.

Source: https://blog.cloudflare.com/private-origins-public-to-private/

Product Update | Cloudflare | Platforms | Oct 30, 2026

Cloudflare WAN Adds Regional Gateway HTTP Inspection for Data Sovereignty

Cloudflare WAN can now process Gateway HTTP traffic in a chosen regional processing region. HTTPS traffic entering over IPsec, GRE or Direct CNI stays encrypted until it reaches that region, where TLS decryption and HTTP inspection happen, letting organizations control where sensitive traffic is inspected. It requires unified routing, covers Gateway HTTP traffic only, and is set up through an account team.

Source: https://developers.cloudflare.com/changelog/post/2026-10-30-cloudflare-wan-regional-processing/

Product Update | Cloudflare | Application Security | Oct 30, 2026

Cloudflare Ships Emergency WAF Rule for Nuxt Image/IPX Vulnerability

Cloudflare released an emergency WAF update adding a Managed Ruleset rule for a vulnerability in Nuxt Image and IPX; the rule is off by default, gives partial coverage, and customers are told to patch. A same-day WAF release updated detections for PHP remote-code-execution and out-of-memory CVEs (CVE-2026-109618, -109619, -115560) across Managed, Free and Response rulesets, following feedback from Cloudflare's PHP Capture the Flag challenge.

Source: https://developers.cloudflare.com/changelog/post/2026-10-30-emergency-waf-release/

Product Update | AWS | AI Data Delivery | Oct 30, 2026

Amazon Bedrock Adds OpenAI GPT-5.6 Runtime APIs and Cross-Region Inference in GovCloud

OpenAI's GPT-5.6 models (Terra and Luna) are now on the Bedrock runtime endpoint in AWS GovCloud (US), with the Responses, Converse and Chat Completions APIs. AWS also added Cross-Region Inference for OpenAI models, spreading requests across GovCloud regions for more throughput while keeping data in the US. Usage ties into existing Bedrock logging, CloudWatch metrics and Cost Explorer reporting.

Source: https://aws.amazon.com/about-aws/whats-new/2026/10/bedrock-openai-runtime-govcloud/

Research | Akamai | AI Security | Oct 30, 2026

Akamai Research: Securing the Agentic Web and the MCP Attack Surface

Akamai published research on how AI agents now appear as attackers, as traffic and as infrastructure, with threats accelerating through MCP servers, agent-to-agent (A2A) protocols, LLM endpoints and agent skills. Akamai argues detection should shift from checking who is calling (bearer identity) to what an agent is allowed to do (intent). Recommended controls include default-deny write access for AI crawlers, WAF, rate and behavior controls on verified bots, and monitoring exposed MCP servers and LLM runtimes.

Source: https://www.akamai.com/blog/ai/frontier-ai-accelerated-attacks-agentic-web-mcp-surface

Product Update | Akamai | AI Security | Oct 30, 2026

Akamai Publishes Workforce Protector Partner Playbook for Browser-Based AI Governance

Akamai released a partner playbook for Akamai Workforce Protector (formerly LayerX), which adds browser-based AI governance and secure-browser controls to Akamai's Zero Trust platform via a lightweight extension for Chrome, Edge, Safari and Firefox. It provides browser-level visibility and real-time policy enforcement for shadow AI. The playbook includes discovery questions, persona pitches and objection handling, positioning the product as an entry point to larger Zero Trust deals.

Source: https://www.akamai.com/blog/partners/security-deal-hiding-in-your-customers-browser

Research | A10 Networks | Application Security | Oct 30, 2026

A10 Details How ThreatX Delivered PHP2Shell Protection in 14 Minutes

A10 Networks Japan posted a technical analysis of the PHP2Shell vulnerability and how its ThreatX WAAP/API protection put coverage in place within 14 minutes of disclosure. PHP2Shell is listed in CISA's KEV catalog and also affected NetScaler ADC/Gateway management interfaces, making it a live competitive talking point for WAAP response speed.

Source: https://www.a10networks.co.jp/news/blog/

Product Update | Arista Networks | AI Data Delivery | Oct 31, 2026

Arista Issues End-of-Sale Notice for DCA-DM-AN660 Analytics Node

Arista issued an end-of-sale/end-of-life notice for its DCA-DM-AN660 Analytics Node, with orders accepted through January 31, 2027 and no direct replacement planned. Support and software updates run through March 31, 2029. Coverage notes Arista's growth still rests on AI networking: 2026 guidance of about $12.6B, AI fabric revenue of roughly $3.5–3.6B, and Etherlink AI switches deployed with more than 100 customers. Q3 results are due November 3.

Source: https://www.ad-hoc-news.de/boerse/news/corporate-news/arista-networks-stock-weighs-ai-momentum-after-product-phaseout-notice/70438489

Product Update | Barracuda Networks | Application Security | Oct 30, 2026

Barracuda Adds AI-Assisted Risk Analysis to Privileged Access Management

Barracuda added AI to its privileged access management (PAM) workflow. When someone requests elevated privileges, the target application is scanned, AI researches the app and checks threat intelligence including VirusTotal, and the reviewer gets a short risk summary with a confidence score. Administrators still make the final approve/deny decision, with each decision logged for audit. Barracuda pitches it to IT teams and MSPs as a way to cut investigation time.

Source: https://blog.barracuda.com/2026/10/30/ai-assisted-privileged-access-management

Product Update | Imperva (Thales) | Application Security | Nov 01, 2026

Thales Imperva Nov 1 Release: Bot Insights Redesign, API Token Validation Scripts, Remote MCP Server Beta

Thales Imperva's Nov 1, 2026 release redesigns the Advanced Bot Protection Traffic Insights dashboard, splitting bad bots into mitigated-stopped, mitigated-challenged and monitored with trend indicators. API Security can now generate validation scripts that test unauthenticated access and token weaknesses. The release also adds a Remote MCP Server in beta for natural-language querying from AI clients, a v3 subaccounts endpoint and stronger OCSP certificate checks in Cloud WAF.

Source: https://docs-cybersec.thalesgroup.com/bundle/cloud-application-security/page/release-notes/2026-11-01.htm

Research | Imperva (Thales) | Application Security | Oct 30, 2026

Imperva Scores 100% in SecureIQLab Cloud WAAP v5.0 Validation, Cited in CSO WAAP Buyer Guidance

A CSO Online guide to choosing a WAAP in 2026 cites SecureIQLab's Cloud WAAP v5.0 test of 12 enterprise platforms across 1,608 attack and 1,487 legitimate-traffic scenarios, with scores ranging from 100% to about 61%. Imperva (Thales) scored 100% with 100% false-positive avoidance, earning a Secure by Default rating and its fifth straight Leader placement. The article urges buyers to weigh blocking and false-positive rates and run proof-of-value tests on their own traffic.

Source: https://www.csoonline.com/article/4242913/choosing-a-waap-in-2026-3-questions-that-separate-the-shortlist.html